Rhapidophyllum hystrix

Needle palm, porcupine palm

Also known as: Blue palmetto | Family: Arecaceae



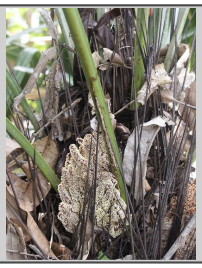
HABIT



OTHER



LEAF





FLOWER / FRUIT

QUICK FACTS

Plant Type: Palm

Evergreen or deciduous
Evergreen

Growth & Size
Rate: Not stated
Size: 3–6 ft tall (occasionally to 8 ft); 4–8 ft wide., clumping habit

Sun

Water

Soil
Prefers organically rich, moist, well-drained soil. Tolerates wet soils and drought once established

Zone 8a
One of the hardiest palms, reliably hardy in Zones 6–10. Well suited to Atlanta Zone 8a; protect from winter winds in colder microclimates

PLANTING NOTES

Establishment
Plant in part shade on rich, moist soil. Mulch in winter in colder sites. Propagate by suckers or seed (slow germination). Avoid root disturbance when transplanting

ORIGIN AND CHARACTERISTICS

Origin
Native to the southeastern United States: South Carolina, Georgia, Florida, Alabama, Mississippi.
Occurs in mesic hammocks and ravine bottoms

Form
Evergreen clumping palm with short, thick trunk covered in sharp black needles 6–10 in long. Large fan-shaped leaves, dark green above, silvery below, to about 3 ft across. Flowers inconspicuous. Fruit small reddish-brown. Considered the most cold-hardy palm. Spreads slowly by suckers to form dense clumps. Valued for tropical appearance in temperate gardens. net

Foliage
Not stated

Flowers and fruit
Not stated

Bark
Not stated

HEALTH

Health
No serious pest or disease problems stated. Sharp needles can injure people and animals. Endangered in the wild; purchase only cultivated plants

Symptoms
None stated